

French A1 — Final Performance Guide

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 12

Overview

Component	Format	Length	When
Part A — Spoken role play	Live conversation with instructor or partner	5–7 minutes	Session 24
Part B — Written message	Short text produced independently	8–10 sentences	Session 24 (in-session or take-home)

Students may refer to their Week 12 phrase bank during Part B. They may not read from a prepared script during Part A — a brief glance at the phrase bank is acceptable.

Part A — Spoken Role Play (5–7 minutes)

Scenario

Student meets someone (the instructor plays the role of a French-speaking stranger) in a social or informal professional setting. The conversation moves through at least three of the four topic areas below.

Four topic areas (student must cover at least three):

1. **Introduction** — name, origin, profession, personal details
2. **Plans** — propose something to do together; suggest a time and place
3. **Directions** — help the other person get somewhere in the city
4. **Description** — describe your home, your neighbourhood, or a place you like

Required Language

The following structures must appear somewhere in the role play:

- ☐ *Être* or *avoir* used correctly at least twice
- ☐ *Aller + infinitif* for at least one near-future plan
- ☐ At least one modal verb (*devoir*, *pouvoir*, or *vouloir*)
- ☐ At least one partitive article (*du*, *de la*, *de l'*, *des*) — naturally, in context
- ☐ At least one question (any formation: inversion, *est-ce que*, or rising intonation)

Students should not try to work through a checklist — they should have a real conversation. These structures will appear naturally if students speak freely.

Scenario Options

The instructor may choose one of the following starting points:

Option A (default): You meet at a café or a community event. You get talking and discover a shared interest. You agree to meet again.

Option B: You are helping a French-speaking visitor who is new to your city. They ask for directions, then you get talking.

Option C: You meet at a language exchange event. You both describe yourselves and your lives, and make a plan to meet for coffee.

In all options, the conversation should feel natural and somewhat improvised — not a performed script.

Student Instructions (Part A)

- Be yourself. Use your own real life as material wherever you can.
 - When you don't know a word, use a communication repair phrase: "*Comment dit-on...?*" or "*Je cherche le mot pour...*"
 - If you lose track, ask: "*Pouvez-vous répéter?*"
 - Getting stuck briefly is normal and not penalized — recovering gracefully is a skill.
 - Do not memorize a script. Practice the topics; improvise the words.
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Part B — Written Message (8–10 sentences)

Task

Write a short message to a French-speaking contact — someone you have just met online or at a language event. They have asked you to introduce yourself.

Your message must include:

- ☐ An introduction: who you are, where you are from, what you do
- ☐ A description of your daily routine (at least 2 sentences)
- ☐ Something you like / love / prefer doing
- ☐ A suggestion to meet or do something together (using *aller + infinitif* or *je voudrais*)
- ☐ At least one question for the other person

Length: 8–10 sentences. Quality over quantity — eight clear, correct sentences are better than twelve muddled ones.

Example opening (student must write their own — not copy this):

Bonjour! Je m'appelle Thomas, j'ai 34 ans et je suis de Londres. Je travaille dans le marketing depuis cinq ans. Le matin, je me lève à sept heures et je prends un café avant de partir au bureau. Le week-end, j'aime faire du vélo — je vais souvent dans le parc près de chez moi. J'adore aussi le cinéma français. Je voudrais visiter Paris l'année prochaine. Est-ce que vous connaissez de bons restaurants à Paris? J'ai hâte de vous connaître.

Student Instructions (Part B)

- Write about your own real life — it is easier and more natural.
 - Use the phrase bank if you need support with vocabulary or sentence starters.
 - You do not need to include health vocabulary or shopping unless you want to.
 - Aim for variety: use different verbs and structures, not just one pattern repeated.
 - Check: verb agreement, adjective agreement, article contractions (*au, du, etc.*).
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A1 Readiness Indicators

A student has demonstrated solid A1 competency when they can:

- ☐ Introduce themselves in 4–5 sentences without preparation

- ☐ Ask and answer basic questions about daily life, work, and interests
 - ☐ Navigate at least 2 transactional scenarios (café, directions, shopping, pharmacy) with some hesitation
 - ☐ Describe their routine, home, or neighbourhood in 4–6 sentences
 - ☐ Use *aller + infinitif* for future plans
 - ☐ Use at least one modal (*devoir, pouvoir, vouloir*) naturally
 - ☐ Write a coherent personal message of 8+ sentences
 - ☐ Recover from communication breakdowns using repair phrases
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A2 Readiness Indicators

A student is approaching A2 readiness when they can also:

- ☐ Sustain a 7-minute conversation without long pauses
- ☐ Describe past events using passé composé (*I went, I ate, I saw...*)
- ☐ Use two or more modals in the same exchange
- ☐ Ask for clarification and rephrase when not understood
- ☐ Write 10+ sentences with consistent grammar and varied vocabulary

The A2 course will focus on: passé composé, imparfait, the distinction between them, futur simple, comparatives/superlatives, and object pronouns.

A Note About Mistakes

Every student who completes the French A1 final performance has done something genuinely difficult — they have learned to communicate in a new language. Mistakes at this level are normal and expected. The goal of A1 is not to be perfect; it is to be understood.

A student who attempts a complex sentence and makes a grammar error is doing something more impressive than a student who only uses patterns they know are safe. Trying more complex language is always the right choice.

Crescere — French A1 Final Performance / Questions? Contact your instructor.